

Leo Torres

Tech Lead Ready for Management Leadership

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Leadership Focus

People Management

- Tech Lead & Direct Manager: Led a team of up to 6 engineers and data scientists; direct manager for up to 5, owning performance reviews and team growth; set technical direction and architecture; held hiring authority for select roles
- Technical Leadership: Leading production ML systems and architecture decisions
- Research to Industry: Bridging academic expertise with business applications
- Strategic Vision: Ready to expand into broader organizational leadership

Research & Development

- Academic Research: PhD in Network Science with publications in top venues
- Software Development: Co-led netrd, XGI, and Manim Community projects
- Conference Organization: Co-organized NetSci satellites and workshops
- Transition Focus: Moving from technical execution to strategic roles

Leadership Experience

FGS Global - Lead Data Scientist & Tech Lead
Berlin, Germany

May 2023 - Present

- Tech lead for a team of up to 6 engineers and data scientists; direct manager for up to 5, owning performance reviews; held hiring authority for select roles
- Built LLM-powered data pipelines processing 10M+ documents daily for Fortune 500 clients
- Technical leadership role combining people management with architecting production systems
- Applied network science methods to large-scale text analysis and information retrieval

Max Planck Institute - Postdoctoral Fellow
Leipzig, Germany

Aug 2021 - May 2023

- Developed spectral theory of non-backtracking operators on graphs
- Applied geometric methods to network analysis and graph embeddings
- Co-led development of open-source software for research community

Network Science Institute - Graduate Researcher
Northeastern University, Boston, MA

2016 - 2021

- PhD research in spectral graph theory and network analysis methods
- Co-led development of netrd library with team of ~6 core developers
- Published research in SIAM Review, Journal of Complex Networks, Applied Network Science
- President of Network Science Institute graduate student association (2018)

Management Philosophy

Servant Leadership & Technical Excellence

- People-First Leadership: Leaders exist to remove obstacles and amplify team impact
- Technical Credibility: Deep technical understanding enables effective architectural guidance
- Psychological Safety: Innovation requires trust; failure becomes learning opportunity
- Clear Vision: Translate organizational goals into inspiring missions connecting daily work to impact
- Continuous Growth: Invest in systematic skill development and career advancement

Open Source Leadership Experience

2019 - Present

github.com/leotrs

- Co-led development of netrd project with team of ~6 core developers
- Established coding standards, review processes, and community guidelines
- NumFOCUS affiliated project leadership (XGI hypergraph library)
- Mentored contributors through technical challenges and career development

Professional Development

- Talk: "LLMs: Computation or Measurement?" - Berlin Data Meetup, 2024 (YouTube)
- Recurse Center: 12-week programming retreat focused on algorithm design and software craftsmanship (2016)

Education

Ph.D. Network Science - Northeastern University, Boston, MA

2016 - 2021

Dissertation: Spectral Aspects of Mining Complex Networks

Advisor: Tina Eliassi-Rad

B.Sc. Mathematics - Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú, Lima

2009 - 2015

Top 3% grades in 75-year history of Sciences Department

Honors Thesis: Small-World Random Graphs Beyond Watts-Strogatz